

4.2b

Developing an argument

Worksheet

- C** Study this text about smoking. Fill in the gaps using words from the diagram on the left in section B. There may be more than one possibility so look carefully at the whole text to see which words are best.

In general, I am a tolerant person. (1) _____, in the case of smoking I think there should be more controls. (2) _____, I believe that it should be stopped completely. I know that smoking gives people pleasure and it's difficult to give up, but it does affect me as a non-smoker. (3) _____, I have to pay extra for the health service with my taxes. (4) _____, I can never find a smoke-free bar – they just don't seem to exist.

Now study this text about education. Fill in the gaps using words from the diagram on the right in section B. There may be more than one possibility so look carefully at the whole text to see which words are best.

(5) _____ it seems that primary schools do a good job in most countries. But at high school level the problems start. (6) _____ that's the case in the U.S. and Britain. Maybe education could be improved if schools had to compete for customers in a free market. The good ones would grow and the bad ones would close. They would receive money from the state according to how many 'customers' (students) they could get. (7) _____, schools would be privatized. This system is not popular with teachers and (8) _____ it hasn't really been tried. But it could be the trend for the future.

- When you have checked your answers read both texts aloud. Try to feel how the speaker is developing the argument.
- Now read again, this time substituting different words from the same groups in section B.

- D** Work in small groups. Choose one of these topics then discuss it. As you speak, try to use some of the language from section B.

- Should smoking be restricted, or is it a freedom? And what about controls on these 'freedoms': owning guns; drinking and driving; owning dangerous dogs to guard houses?
- Is there a trend in your country for high schools (secondary schools) to be 'privatized'? Would the changes suggested in the text lead to chaos? Would children from poor areas have a choice? What other changes are happening in your education system?

- E** Choose a topic from the lists, or one of your own. Write a short dialogue between two people discussing the topic. Remember to include phrases from section B.

General

UFOs
New buildings in historic city centers
Will American culture become world culture?
A new leisure technology
Job mobility, unemployment and families
Save the tiger! Save the panda! Why?
Surviving on a desert island
A current news item

Business

The latest trends in marketing
Privatization
Dealing with a complaint
Choosing the right supplier
Collecting money from slow payers
Business and the environment
The latest trends in financial services
A current news item

